



CALICUT UNIVERSITY – FOUR-YEAR UNDERGRADUATE PROGRAMME (CU-FYUGP)

BA ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE HONOURS

Programme	BA ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE HONOURS				
Course Code	ENG8EJ404				
Course Title	WRITINGS OF THE SELF				
Type of Course	ELECTIVE				
Semester	VIII				
Academic Level	400-499				
Course Details	Credit	Lecture per week	Tutorial per week	Practical per week	Total Hours
	4	4	-	-	60
Pre-requisites	1. General aptitude to read and appreciate life narratives across cultures. 2. Empathy and an open mind to recognise the author's perspective. 3. Willingness to engage with challenging ideas and consider alternative interpretations.				
Course Summary	Readings from a range of genres of life writing, memoir, testimony etc to familiarise with the social relevance of the genre in the contexts of societal oppression, stigma, and stereotyping to engage in then current debates of the authenticity of self in the digital context.				

Course Outcomes (CO):

CO	CO Statement	Cognitive Level*	Knowledge Category#	Evaluation Tools used
CO1	To understand the concept of life writing and explore its significance in literature and personal expression.	U	C	Instructor-created exams / Quiz
CO2	To identify and differentiate between the various genres of life writing	Ap	F	One minute Reflection/ Writing Assignment/ In-class Discussions
CO3	To develop an appreciation for the diverse cultural perspectives and experiences reflected in life writing texts from across the globe.	U	C	Seminar Presentation
CO4	To critically analyse autobiographies to examine themes, motives, and narrative structures	An	P	Tests
CO5	To develop a broad understanding of lived experiences of peoples from the margins of race, ethnicity, caste, gender and the like.	F	C	Clicker questions/ Project/Quiz/In -class Discussions
C06	To appreciate and understand the various intersections that shape autobiographical narratives.	Ap	p	Assignments
* - Remember (R), Understand (U), Apply (Ap), Analyse (An), Evaluate (E), Create (C) # - Factual Knowledge(F) Conceptual Knowledge (C) Procedural Knowledge (P) Metacognitive Knowledge (M)				

Detailed Syllabus:

Module	Unit	Content	Hrs	Marks 70
I	INTRODUCTION TO SELF-WRITINGS		8	17
	1	What is Life Writing?	2	
	2	Forms of Life Writing- Essay, Autobiography, Memoir, Testimony	2	
	3	Historical overview of Life writing	1	
	4	Fundamental concepts and themes in Autobiography-identity, memory, agency	3	
		Suggested Activity: 1. Collect samples of personal writing, Diary, Testimony		
II	IDENTITY AND BELONGINGNESS		12	18
	5	Introduction to the Socio- Political context of each text	3	
	6	The Survivor-Marilyn Chin	3	
	7	“Complexion” Chapter IV of <i>Hunger for Memory: The Education of Richard Rodriguez</i> , Bantam Books.	3	
	8	Some Accounts of my Early Life “from A True Tale of Slavery” from <i>Incidents in the Life of a Slave Girl</i> by Harriet Jacobs, Penguin Books. pg. 231-33.	3	
		Suggested Activity: 1. Collect life writings from various nations for cross cultural understanding		
III	STRUGGLES AND RESILIENCE		14	18
	9	Introduction to the Socio- Political context of each text	3	
	10	Letters from a Man in Solitary-Nazim Hikmet (www.poetrysoup.com/famous/poem/letters_from_a_man_in_solitary_17656)	4	
	11	“There are many Things more Precious than Money” Chapter I from <i>The Happiest Man on Earth</i> - Eddie Jaku, Pan Macmillan Australia.	4	
	12	Excerpts from Chapter III “Don’t Stare, Just Ask” from the book <i>Born Just Right</i> by Jordan Reeves and Jen Lee Reeves, Jeter Children’s Aladdin.	3	
		Suggested Activity: Class group work on subaltern life narratives		
IV	SOCIAL JUSTICE AND ACTIVISM		14	17
	13	Introduction to the Socio- Political context of each text	2	
	14	Chapter VIII of <i>Sangati: Events</i> by Bama, translated by Lakshmi Holmstrom, Oxford University P. pg. 79-90.	2	
	15	Chapter VIII “Activism” from <i>Our Lives, Our Words: Telling Aravani Lifestories</i> by A. Revathi, translated by A. Mangai, Yoda Press 2011 pg. 72-77.	2	
	16	Chapter I “Beginnings” of <i>Unbowed: A Memoir</i> by Wangari Maathai	2	
	17	Unreadable Dreams-Anindita Bose	2	
	18	The Woman who watches over the World, Chapter 1- Linda Hogan	2	
		Suggested Activities: Read blogs and attempt blog writing on personal experiences		
V	OPEN ENDED		12	

Note: The course is divided into five modules, with four having total 18 fixed units and one open-ended module with a variable number of units. There are total 48 instructional hours for the fixed modules and 12 hours for the open-ended one. Internal assessments (30 marks) are split between the open-ended module (10 marks) and the fixed modules (20 marks). The final exam, however, covers only the 18 units from the fixed modules.

Suggested Reading:

1. Chapter I Life Narrative: Definition and Distinctions
2. Chapter II Autobiographical Subjects
3. Chapter IV Life Narratives in Historical Perspective
4. Autobiography: A Guide for Interpreting Life Narratives- Sidonie Smith and Julia Watson
5. <https://poemotopia.com/marilyn-chin/the-survivor/>
6. *Hunger for Memory: The Education of Richard Rodriguez*, Bantam Books.
7. "Introduction" in Jean Fagan Yellin's *Incidents in the Life of a Slave Girl: Written by Herself*, ed. Jean Fagan Yellin (Cambridge: Harvard University Press, 1987), xiii—xxxiv.
8. *Poems of Nazim Hikmet* translated from Turkish by Randy Blasing and Mutlu Kunak, Persea books, 1994.
9. *Holocaust and Memory: The Experience of the Holocaust and its Consequences, An Investigation Based on Personal Narratives* Barbara Engelking, Gunnar Paulsson, Bloomsbury T&T Clark, 2001.
10. file:///C:/Users/Home/Downloads/6909-Article%20Text-12343-4-10-20240212.pdf. (On Sangati)
11. https://www.rupkatha.com/V7/n3/22_hijra-transgender-identities.pdf
12. <https://www.scribd.com/document/516115177/Unbowed-Chapter-1>

Mapping of COs with PSOs and POs:

	PSO 1	PSO 2	PSO 3	PSO 4	PSO 5	PSO 6	P O 1	P O 2	PO 3	PO 4	PO 5	PO6
CO 1	1	2	3	1	2	2	1	2	-	2	2	1
CO 2	2	3	2	2	3	2	2	1	-	2	1	3
CO 3	2	2	3	3	2	2	1	3	1	-	2	2
CO 4	1	2	3	3	3	3		2	1	1	-	3
CO 5	1	2	3	2	3	3	2		2	2	-	2
CO 6	1	2	3	2	3	3	1		1	2	1	3

Correlation Levels:

Level	Correlation
-	Nil
1	Slightly / Low
2	Moderate / Medium
3	Substantial / High

Assessment Rubrics:

- Quiz / Assignment/ Quiz/ Discussion / Seminar
- Midterm Exam
- Programming Assignments (20%)
- Final Exam (70%)

Mapping of Cos to Assessment Rubrics:

	Quiz/ Discussion/ Seminar (10%)	Internal Exam (10%)	Assignment (10%)	End Semester Exam (70%)
CO 1	✓	✓	✓	✓
CO 2	✓	✓	✓	✓
CO 3	✓	✓	✓	✓
CO 4	✓	✓	✓	✓
CO 5	✓	✓	✓	✓
C06	✓	✓	✓	✓